Local Market Benchmark Builder

Market: _____ **Date:** _____

Part A: Before you fall for anything.

Takes in: ten AS-04 calls.

Hands to: AS-02 (the screen), AS-19 (the decision).

Your rent number is not a guess, and it is not the broker's comp sheet. Build it from ten calls you made yourself.

Built for MHC lot-rent math. RV parks run different economics.

1. The ten calls

- [ ] Call 10 parks within 30 minutes of yours, as a prospective tenant. Five minutes each (AS-04).
- [ ] Log every call the same day: lot rent, what is included, fees, availability, waitlist, condition from the drive-by.
- [ ] Write down their exact words on rent and rules. Paraphrase is where the padding hides.

2. Rent comps

Park	Lot rent ($)	Utilities included?	Fees	Vacancy / waitlist	Notes

Two-page tool: the ten calls and the rent comps on this page, the read guide and the number on the next page.

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3. How to read the table

- Compare like with like: only parks where tenants pay their own electric, or adjust by the real utility cost first.
- Sort by lot rent. The median is your anchor, not the average: one luxury park warps the average.
- Strike any park more than 30 minutes out or serving a different tenant. Distance kills the comp.
- A park that discounts to fill is not a comp for your rent. It is a warning about the market.

4. Fee comps

Fee	Your park	Market range
Application fee		
Deposit		
Late fee		
Pet fee		
Rule-violation fee		

5. Competition and demand

- Map the competition: who is full, who is discounting to fill, who is falling apart.
- Demand drivers: employers, hospitals, highways, lakes. Write down the three nearest to your park.
- Your edge, one sentence: why a tenant picks your park over the one down the road.

Demand driver 1: _____

Demand driver 2: _____

Demand driver 3: _____

6. The number

Market-supported lot rent ($): _____ **Current lot rent ($):** _____

The gap between those two numbers is your upside. It is also your risk, if closing the gap takes evictions to achieve.

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Worked example: Maple Bend Estates, fictional

Fictional. The seller claims $410 average lot rent on 44 occupied lots. The buyer makes ten calls. Maple Bend tenants pay their own electric, so all ten comps are electric-separate parks within 30 minutes.

Call	Lot rent ($)	Availability
1	375	Full
2	385	Full
3	390	Full
4	395	Waitlist
5	400	Full
6	400	Full
7	405	Full
8	410	Full
9	415	Discounting to fill
10	425	Full

Sorted, the middle two rents are $400 and $400. Median = $400. Market-supported lot rent: $400.

The seller's $410 claim sits $10 above the median: 10 / 400 = 2.5% over. The walk already showed 41 occupied lots, not 44: 41 / 48 = 85.4% against the claimed 91.7%. Rent at the top of the market and occupancy below the claim. There is no lot-rent upside to pay for here.

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The Doctrine

The belief this tool shatters is that the rent number lives in the broker's package or in your gut. The package shows what the seller wishes the market pays. Your gut shows what you hope the park earns. Neither one is a comp. The market is ten phone calls you made yourself, from a number the seller does not know, logged the same day. The rule is one sentence: the market-supported rent is the median of your ten calls, adjusted for what the rent includes, and you do not pay for rent the market will not give you. Upside you can prove is an asset. Upside you assume is a donation to the seller.

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